

Sandith Hewage

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EDUCATION

University of California San Diego

Bachelor of Science in Cognitive Science (Specialization in Design & Interaction)

Relevant Coursework: UX Design, Interaction Design, Data Science, Cognitive Neuroscience

Expected June 2027

La Jolla, CA

EXPERIENCE

Y STEM and Chess Inc | Full Stack Software Engineer Intern · San Diego, CA

June 2026 – Present

- Led a full-stack redesign of a nonprofit chess, math, and CS platform serving 500+ underserved students
- Built an AI chess tutor that gives students move feedback and hints, helping them learn as they play
- Conducted user research with students and educators to shape user flows for neurodivergent learners
- Built a mobile-first, accessible design system with a design.md spec that lets AI agents build on-brand UI
- Ships front-end features in HTML, CSS, and JavaScript using Claude Code, partnering with program staff

Scabs | Co-Founder & UX/Product Designer · Los Angeles, CA

September 2024 – Present

- Designs and builds the Shopify storefront in HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and Liquid; first drop earned \$8,900
- Redesigned checkout through competitive analysis and usability testing, replacing the cart with an interactive sizing calculator that cut sizing inquiries by an estimated 40%
- Creates visual identity, UI, product graphics, and campaign assets for web, packaging, and social
- Iterates on Figma mockups using mobile analytics showing 80%+ of traffic comes from Instagram

2nd Street USA | Sales Associate & Assistant Buyer · Torrance, CA

November 2023 – November 2024

- Promoted in 7 months; scaled listings from 5 to 30 per week, lifting daily sales revenue by 23%
- Evaluated secondhand apparel and luxury inventory for resale potential, condition, and pricing

PROJECTS

Queue: Restaurant Wait Experience Design

sandith.com/queue

- Researched 16 diners and designed a wait system using confidence ranges instead of timers
- Prototyped in Figma and validated with 7 participants, who unanimously preferred it

Smart DND: iOS Notification Redesign

sandith.com/smart-dnd

- Researched 18 users and found iOS Focus organizes around apps, while users think in terms of people
- Prototyped a cross-app prioritization system with a transparent reasoning UI, understood by all 5 testers

MTS Trolley Doors: Transit Interaction Design

sandith.com/mts

- Interviewed and observed 30 riders, uncovering a critical feedback gap in the trolley door interface
- Designed a four-state door interaction model using brightness, shape, and color for accessible feedback

SKILLS

Design: Figma, User Research, Usability Testing, Wireframing, Prototyping, Interaction Design, Visual Design, Design Systems, Information Architecture, Journey Mapping, Competitive Analysis, Accessible Design

Development: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Shopify Liquid, Python, Git, Claude API

Tools: Claude Code, Claude Design, Adobe Creative Cloud, GitHub, Shopify